

House Construction: Cost Estimation & Budget Management Survey

We are conducting a short academic survey to understand the challenges people face when estimating the cost of constructing a new home.

The survey takes **2–3 minutes** and does not ask for any personally identifying or sensitive financial information. Your responses will be used only for academic research as part of our Market Research & Validation project.

Thank you for sharing your experience!

* Indicates required question

1. Have you constructed a new house before or are you currently constructing one? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Currently constructing
- ☐ Constructed within last 2 years
- ☐ Constructed 2–5 years ago
- ☐ Constructed more than 5 years ago
- ☐ Planning to construct

2. What was/will be your approximate construction budget? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ < ₹25L
- ☐ ₹25–50L
- ☐ ₹50L–₹1Cr
- ☐ ₹1–2Cr
- ☐ > ₹2Cr

3. How did you initially estimate your construction budget? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Contractor estimate
- ☐ Architect estimate
- ☐ Own calculation
- ☐ Previous experience
- ☐ Friends/family
- ☐ Combination of multiple sources
- ☐ Other:

4. How confident were you in your initial budget estimate? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Very confident
- ☐ Somewhat confident
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Not very confident
- ☐ Not confident at all

5. How different was the final construction cost from your initial estimate? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Almost the same
- ☐ Up to 10% higher
- ☐ 10-20% higher
- ☐ 20-30% higher
- ☐ More than 30% higher
- ☐ Still under construction / Don't know

6. What were the main reasons for the difference between the estimated and actual cost? (select all that apply) *

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ Increase in material prices
- ☐ Labour cost changes
- ☐ Contractor charges
- ☐ Changes in design/requirements
- ☐ Additional/unplanned work
- ☐ Material wastage
- ☐ Construction delays
- ☐ Unexpected repairs/issues
- ☐ Forgotten/missed expenses during initial estimation
- ☐ No significant difference
- ☐ Other: _____

7. Did you compare quotations from multiple contractors? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes, 3 or more
- ☐ Yes, 2
- ☐ No, only one
- ☐ Not applicable

8. How did you track your construction expenses during the project? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Excel/Google Sheets
- ☐ Notebook/manual records
- ☐ WhatsApp/messages
- ☐ Contractor maintained records
- ☐ Bank/payment records
- ☐ App/software
- ☐ I did not actively track expenses
- ☐ Other:

9. How did you determine the prices of construction materials when preparing your initial estimate? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Contractor provided the prices
- ☐ Checked prices from local suppliers
- ☐ Compared prices from multiple suppliers
- ☐ Checked prices online
- ☐ Based on previous experience
- ☐ Didn't check independently
- ☐ Other:

10. How difficult was it to keep the construction within your planned budget? *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Very difficult

☐ Difficult

☐ Neutral

☐ Easy

☐ Very easy

11. How often did you compare actual spending with your planned budget? *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Daily

☐ Weekly

☐ Monthly

☐ Only when major expenses occurred

☐ Only at the end

☐ Never

12. If a tool could provide a reliable estimate of your total construction cost before you begin, based on your location, house size, materials and other requirements, how likely would you be to use it? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Definitely would use
- ☐ Probably would use
- ☐ Not sure
- ☐ Probably wouldn't use
- ☐ Definitely wouldn't use

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